

Fast Group

User Manual

A REAPER script for grouping and synchronizing tracks

Emelowsky

Document version 1.9 (Manager 3.13, Popup 1.10)

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1. Introduction

Fast Group is a REAPER script that lets you link any number of tracks into a “proportion group” — from that moment on, changing a linked parameter on one track in the group automatically and proportionally carries over to the other tracks in the same group, with no need to select them by hand every time.

The script consists of three files, which must all live in ONE folder:

- `Emelowsky - Fast Group Core.lua` — the shared logic library (does not open any window on its own).
- `Emelowsky - Fast Group (manager).lua` — the main Manager window with the track table.
- `Emelowsky - Fast Group (Popup).lua` — a small, independent popup for quick group add/remove.

The Manager and the Popup can be used independently, under two separate keyboard shortcuts, and can even be kept open at the same time — any change made in one appears immediately in the other, because both read and write the same data stored in the project.

The script is one set of files that works in two modes:

- **DEMO mode** — without a license, works right away: a maximum of 2 active groups at a time, settings in Options locked (chapter 4).
- **Full version** — after you activate a license (chapter 3), no limitations; activation works right away, with no other files to install.

> **Tip:** There are no separate full and DEMO files — the same set of three files works as DEMO or as the full version, depending on the license.

2. Requirements and installation

2.1 What you need

- REAPER 7 (latest stable version recommended) or REAPER 6 — on REAPER 6 use the files from the “Lua 5.3 (REAPER 6)” folder of the package (details in “Fast Group - REAPER 6 (Lua 5.3) PLEN.txt”).
- The ReaImGui extension, installed through ReaPack (Extensions → ReaPack → Browse packages…, search for “ReaImGui”, install it, then restart REAPER). Without this extension the script shows an error message and will not start.
- (Optional) the js_ReaScriptAPI extension — installed via ReaPack. With it, “always on top” windows don't flicker while you move them and go behind another program when you click it. Without it, Fast Group works normally.
- A screen with scaling above 100% (common on laptops): REAPER must run in the “Multimonitor aware” HiDPI mode (Options → Preferences → General → Advanced UI/system tweaks → HiDPI mode, then restart REAPER). In any other mode ReaImGui cannot open the window — Fast Group then shows what to do (section 11).

2.2 Installing the files

1. Copy all three .lua files into one folder, e.g. Scripts/Fast Group/ (REAPER 7: the files from the “Lua 5.4 (REAPER 7)” folder, REAPER 6: from the “Lua 5.3 (REAPER 6)” folder).
2. In REAPER: Actions → Show action list… → New action… → Load ReaScript…, and pick the “…(manager).lua” file.
3. Assign it a keyboard shortcut (Add / right-click the action → shortcut).

4. Repeat steps 2-3 for the "…(Popup).lua" file, assigning a DIFFERENT shortcut than the Manager.

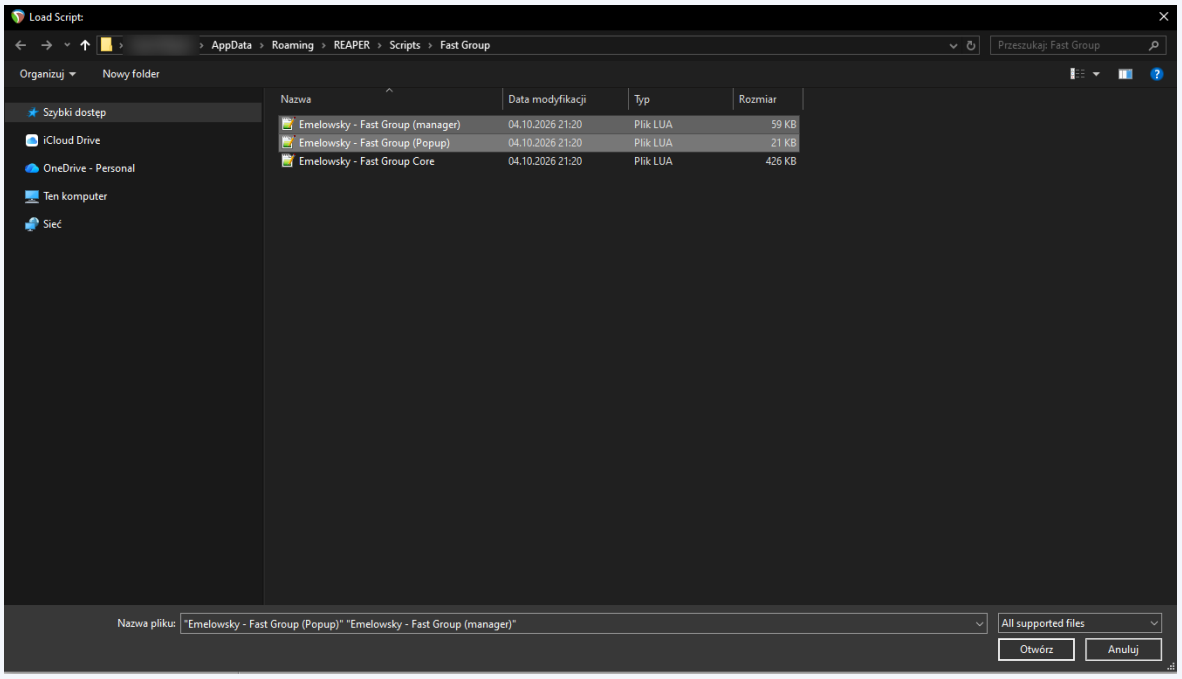
> **Important:** When assigning the shortcut, set its Scope to "Global + text fields", not just "Global" — this makes the shortcut work even when a text field inside the script's own window currently has focus.

Each of these two scripts (Manager and Popup) registers as ONE action/ONE shortcut that toggles its window open and closed — exactly like REAPER's own native windows (e.g. the Mixer). You don't have to close it with the window's [X] button, though that also works. Grouping only works while the Manager is running: when you turn it off, the group badges disappear from your tracks (a sign that the groups are paused), and when you start it again they come back together with all their offsets. The groups stay in the project the whole time.

The Core.lua file has no shortcut of its own — it is loaded automatically by both the Manager and the Popup, and must sit in the same folder as both of them. Don't load it into the Action List: it is a library, and run as an action it only shows a message that it is a library.

Installing with ReaPack (instead of copying by hand): Extensions → ReaPack → Import repositories… and paste https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Emelowsky/reapack/main/index.xml, then Extensions → ReaPack → Browse packages… → search for "Fast Group" → tick "Emelowsky - Fast Group" (on REAPER 6: "Emelowsky - Fast Group (REAPER 6, Lua 5.3)") → Install → Apply. Updates then arrive by themselves (Extensions → ReaPack → Synchronize packages).

Note — different folder: ReaPack installs the files into Scripts/Emelowsky/Fast Group (with an extra "Emelowsky" folder), not Scripts/Fast Group as in the manual install. ReaPack adds both actions (Manager and Popup) to the Action List for you and installs Core without an action — skip steps 1–2 and 4, and set the shortcuts (step 3) the same way. Pick one way of installing; the groups are saved in the project, so they work with both. Moving from a manual install to ReaPack? Remove the old copy: the Scripts/Fast Group folder (or wherever you copied the files) and its actions in the Action List (Remove). Two copies cannot run at once — the second one only shows a message that Fast Group is already running from another location.



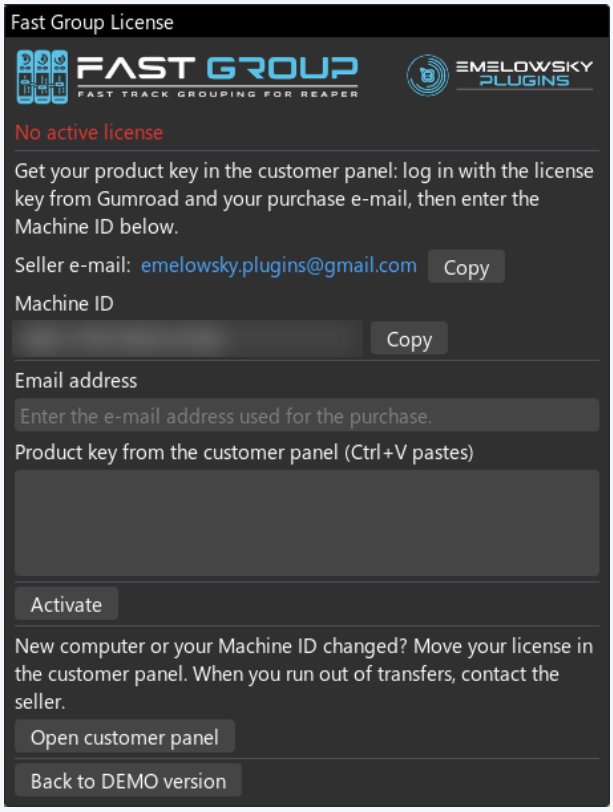
The "Load ReaScript…" dialog with the (manager).lua file selected

3. License activation

Activation is fully automatic and does not need a permanent internet connection. At activation and from time to time afterwards, the script checks in the background whether the license has been revoked. Having no internet or no connection to the server does not get in your way — the script keeps working normally and never deactivates your license because of it.

3.1 Find your Machine ID

1. In the Manager window, click “I have a key - activate” next to the “⚠ DEMO VERSION ⚠” banner (or Options → “About” → the same button). The license window opens.
2. You will see your unique **Machine ID** (format XXXX-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX). Click **“Copy”** to copy it to the clipboard.
3. Click “Open customer panel” and log in with the license key from Gumroad (it came by e-mail after your purchase) and the email address used at purchase. Paste the Machine ID — the panel issues a product key for this computer. Questions: emelowsky.plugins@gmail.com (the address is also shown in the license window — “Copy” button).



The license window showing the Machine ID, the seller's e-mail and the Copy buttons

3.2 Activate your product key

1. Enter the same email address in the license window and paste the WHOLE product key into the “Product key from the customer panel” field (the field is multi-line — paste the entire block at once). Note: this is not the Gumroad license key — that one is only for logging in to the panel.
2. Click **“Activate”**.

3. After a moment you will see “License activated successfully!”. The script works as the full version right away — no restart needed, also in an open Popup window — and Options → “License” shows “License active” together with the email address the copy is registered to.

> **Note:** The key will be rejected if the email address differs from the one you provided when ordering, or if it is pasted on a different computer than the one it was generated for. In both cases the script shows a clear error message explaining why. If your computer or Machine ID changed, move your license in the customer panel (section 3.3).

Until a license is activated, Fast Group runs in DEMO mode (chapter 4) — every window works, only the DEMO limitations apply. The “Back to DEMO version” button at the bottom of the license window closes it without activating.

3.3 Deactivation and moving your license

To remove the license from this computer, open Options → “License” (the last section), click the red “Deactivate license” button and confirm in the “Confirm deactivation” window. The script switches to DEMO mode right away, and your groups stay in the project.

New computer, or your Machine ID changed (e.g. after reinstalling the system)? The key is tied to the Machine ID, so the old key will not work on the new computer. Move your license in the customer panel — the “Customer panel” button is in the license window and in Options → “About”. In the panel you get a new key for the new Machine ID, and the license on the previous computer is revoked. The number of self-service transfers is limited — when you run out, contact the seller.

3.4 Revoked license

If the license is revoked (e.g. after moving it to another computer, or after a refund), the script shows the message “This license has been revoked by the license server…” and switches to DEMO mode; the license window keeps showing the message. The same key cannot be activated again — you need a new key from the customer panel or from the seller.

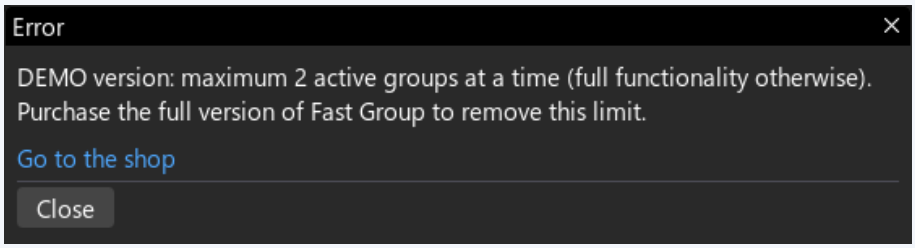
4. DEMO mode

Without an active license, Fast Group runs in DEMO mode — right away, with no activation, with full functionality (all parameters, badges, languages, templates) and two limitations: a maximum of 2 simultaneously active groups per project, and the settings in the Options panel are locked (except the language and the “About” section).

Trying to create a third active group does not create it — instead a window appears explaining the limit, with a “Buy license” button that opens the shop page.

At the top of both windows (Manager and Popup) you see “⚠ DEMO VERSION ⚠” — in the Manager with an “I have a key - activate” button — a repeating “DEMO” watermark in the background, and the footer at the bottom of the window shows “License: NONE” together with a purchase prompt.

If the project has more groups than DEMO mode allows (e.g. after deactivating the license, or in a project from the full version), the extra groups are NOT removed — they stay in the project but aren't synced, and a message under the DEMO banner says so. After you activate a license, they work again.



The DEMO limit window with the “Go to the shop” link

Purchasing and activating a license (chapter 3) removes this limitation at any time — without losing any existing groups.

5. Main window — Manager

The Manager is the script's main window: it shows a table of every track in the project together with its group membership.

5.1 Top bar

- **Chain link (Sync: ON / OFF)** — green and closed = sync on, red and open = sync off. Sync: OFF pauses synchronization: the groups stay in the project (with their names and colors), and the badges disappear from your tracks so you can see that grouping is paused. Turn it off briefly, adjust one track, and turn it back on — on Sync: ON the offsets of all groups are recalculated from the current levels, so your change becomes part of the group's balance.
- **“+” (Quick add)** — opens and closes the window described in chapter 8 (also available via Ctrl+G while the Manager window is focused).
- **List (Manage groups)** — opens and closes the window with the full list of groups for editing, see section 6.3.
- **Page (Manage templates)** — opens and closes the templates window, see chapter 7.
- **Arrow (Show / Hide actions)** — hides/shows an extra row of letter buttons V P R M S A W F right under the bar (hidden by default).

Quick add, Manage groups and Manage templates are switches: the same button opens the window and closes it, just like Sync. While the window is open the icon keeps its colour; when it's closed the icon is grey.

Closing the window with the X in its top-right corner also switches the button off. None of these windows block the Manager — you can keep clicking tracks, faders and buttons in the main window at the same time.

The buttons show icons instead of names — hold the mouse over an icon for a second to see a tooltip with its name. You can move any window (Manager, Quick add, Manage groups, Manage templates, Options) by dragging an empty spot with the mouse.

Docking: drag the Manager window with Shift held down onto a spot in REAPER's docker. You take it out of the docker with a normal drag or right-click → Undock. By default the windows stay always on top, but only over REAPER: when you click another program they go behind its window, and come back on top when you return to REAPER. REAPER warnings, questions and dialogs always show above the Fast Group windows. A docked window is not “always on top”.

5.2 Search field

The Filter field searches both the track name and the group name/number at the same time. You can type several words or parts of words separated by spaces — only rows containing ALL of the typed words (in any order, case-insensitive) will be shown, e.g. “kick in” finds the track “Kick In”.

5.3 Track table

Each row represents one track in the project. A colored “ribbon” on the right side of the row shows its group membership (a single color = one group; several colored segments = the track belongs to several groups at once); you can set its width in Options (1–100% of the row). The track name is centered on the ribbon, and you can set its font, color and automatic contrast with the group color in Options → “Font and appearance”. Right-clicking a row opens a context menu:

- Add group — creates a new group from the selected tracks.
- Add to group — attaches the selected tracks to an existing group.
- Edit group — changes the linked parameters of an existing group.
- Remove from group — detaches the selected tracks from the group (the group remains for the others).
- Remove group — deletes the whole group.



The Manager main window with groups on the ribbon; the Manage groups button switched on (purple)

5.4 Tools menu

- Quick add / remove… (Ctrl+G) — see chapter 8.
- Manage templates… — see chapter 7.
- Remove ALL groups… — deletes every group in the project at once, after confirmation.
- Recalculate offsets of all groups — resets the proportion reference point relative to the current fader levels.
- Clean up unused group data — removes leftover dead entries from tracks that no longer exist.
- Refresh track group badges — forces the group badge icons (chapter 10) to redraw.
- Debug: view group data — a technical view of the raw data, useful when reporting an issue.

6. Creating and managing groups

6.1 Parameters to choose from

When creating or editing a group you choose which parameters should be linked. They fall into two kinds:

- **Proportional** (Volume, Pan, Width) — preserve the difference between tracks: moving a fader on one track moves the others by the SAME amount, not to the same level.
- **Synced** (Mute, Solo, Record Arm, Polarity/phase) — copy the exact same state to every track in the group (toggle it on one — the others follow).

Reverse Pan is a special case: it only works for groups of exactly TWO tracks, and mirrors pan changes (when one track pans right, the other pans left by the same amount).

6.2 Creating a new group

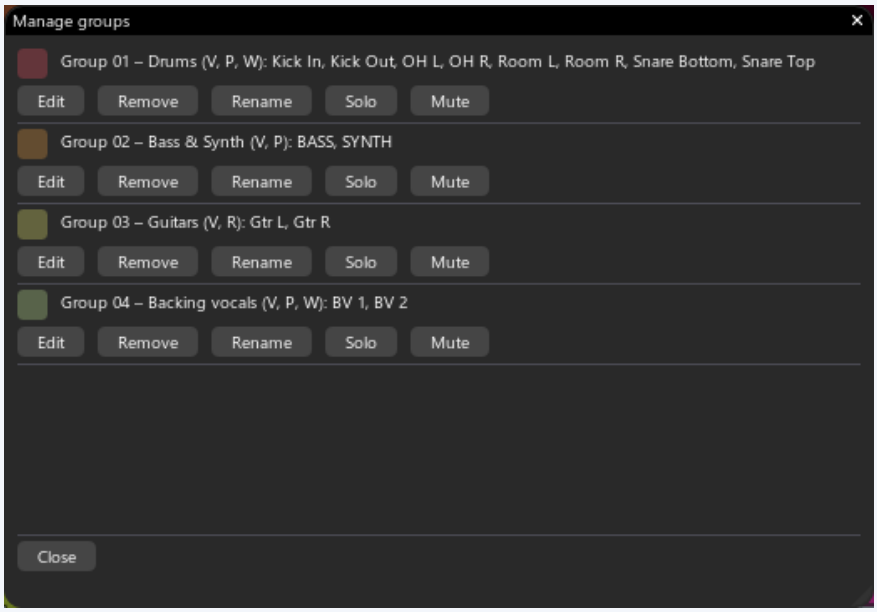
1. Select at least two tracks in REAPER (exactly two for Reverse Pan).
2. In the Manager table, right-click and choose **“Add group”** (or use the Quick add popup, chapter 8).
3. Tick the checkboxes for the parameters you want to link, then click **“Create”**.

If the selected tracks already match an existing group with an identical parameter configuration, they are merged into it instead of creating a duplicate.

6.3 Manage groups

The “Manage groups” button opens a resizable window listing every active group. The window works next to the Manager and does not block it — you can select tracks in the table or in REAPER at the same time. For each group you see:

- the list of tracks belonging to the group,
- checkboxes for the linked parameters (Volume/Pan/Reverse Pan/Mute/Solo/Record Arm/Width/Polarity),
- a colored swatch with the group's automatic color (informational),
- **“Solo”** / **“Mute”** — quick toggles.
- **“Rename”** — gives the group its own, readable name.
- **“Edit”** — changes the set of linked parameters.
- **“Save as template”** — saves the current parameter combination as a reusable template (chapter 7).
- **“Delete”** — deletes the group.



The “Manage groups” window with the group list and buttons

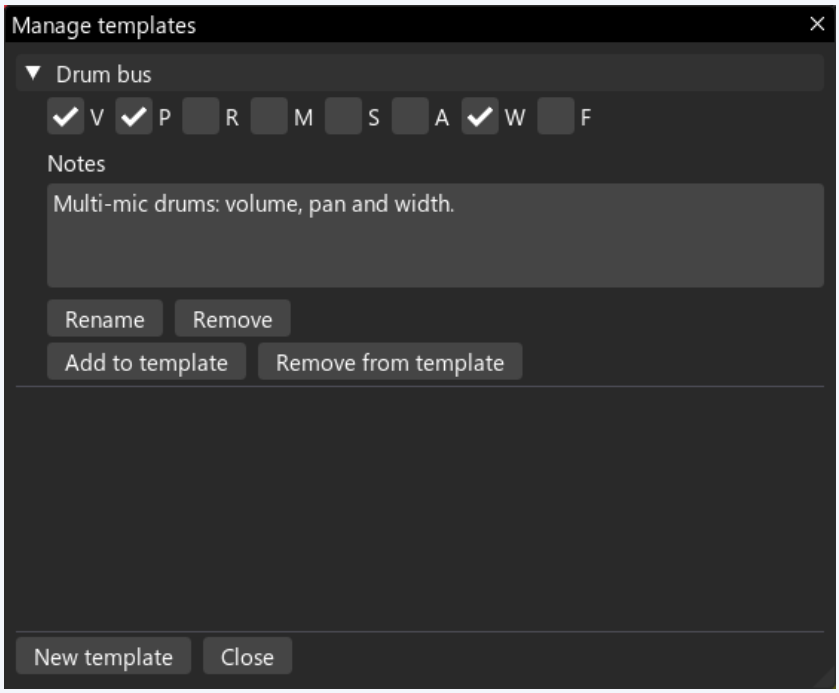
7. Group templates

A template is a remembered combination of parameters (plus optional notes) that can be instantly applied to any selected tracks, without re-ticking the checkboxes every time.

The “Manage templates” window (Tools menu → Manage templates…) lets you:

- create a new, empty template and set its parameters;
- rename or delete an existing template;
- add free-form notes to the template;
- **“Add to template”** — applies the template's parameters to the tracks currently selected in REAPER (creates a new group, or joins a matching existing one).
- **“Remove from template”** — removes the selected tracks from the group matching that template.

A group created from a template is marked on the tracks with a distinctive ring-shaped badge (instead of a solid color) — so it's immediately visible which groups came from a saved template (see chapter 10).



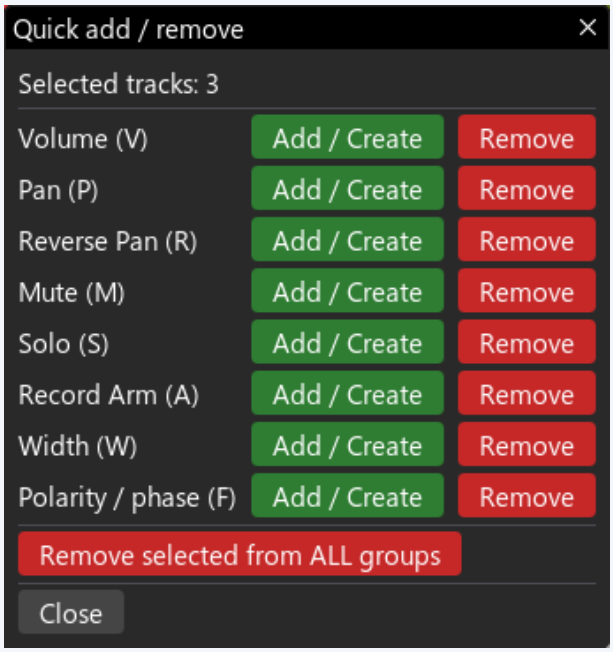
The “Manage templates” window with one template expanded

8. Quick add / remove

This small window (available from the button in the Manager, via the Ctrl+G shortcut, or as a completely separate “(Popup).lua” script under its own keyboard shortcut) shows one row of eight letter buttons, one per parameter:

- V — Volume, P — Pan, R — Reverse Pan, M — Mute, S — Solo, A — Record Arm, W — Width, F — Polarity/phase.

The green row (Add / Create) adds the tracks currently selected in REAPER to the group for that ONE parameter (creating it if it doesn't exist yet). The red row (Remove) detaches the selected tracks from that parameter's group. An additional “Remove selected from ALL groups” button removes the tracks from every group at once, in a single click.

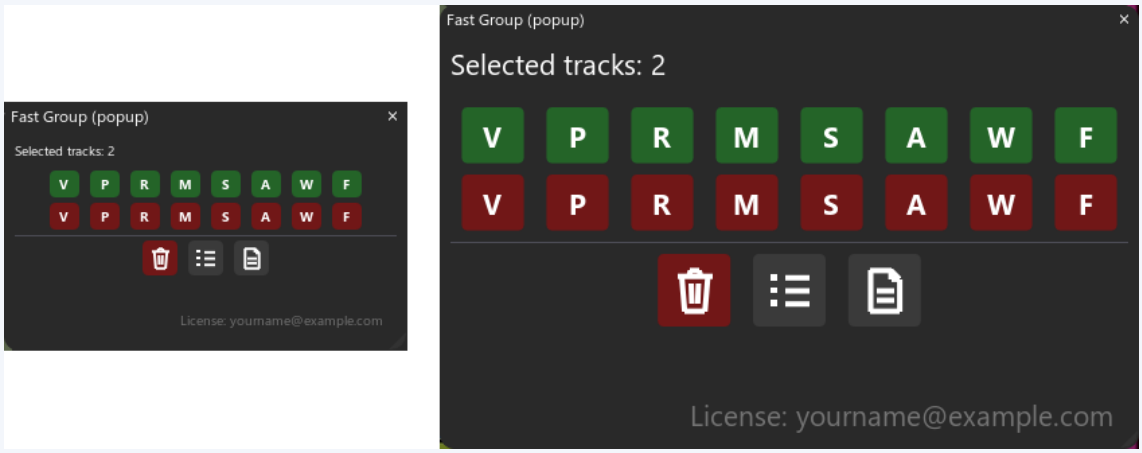


The "Quick add / remove" popup with its green and red letter rows

The independent Popup script additionally has icon buttons: a trash can — "Remove all" (deletes every group in the project, with confirmation), a list — "Manage groups" (the same window as in the Manager, section 6.3) and a page — "Manage templates" (chapter 7). The list and the page are switches, just like in the Manager. This way groups can be fully managed without ever opening the large Manager window.

Popup window scale

You choose the size of the letters, buttons and icons in the Popup window from a list in the Manager: Options → Window → "Popup window" → "Popup window scale", from 20% to 200% in 20% steps. 100% is the font size set in Font and appearance. Changes apply right away, without restarting the Popup. Text is always drawn at its final size instead of being stretched or shrunk, so it stays sharp at every scale. You can resize the Popup window freely — the content keeps the chosen scale. At a small scale the "Bold letters on buttons" option helps — the V P R M S A W F letters are easier to read.



The Popup window at a small and a large scale (here with bold letters)

9. Options panel

The Options panel is a separate, movable, resizable window. At the very top you choose the interface language (PL / EN / DE / FR / ES buttons; the change also applies to the Popup window right away, and on first launch the script is in English). Below are the settings, grouped into collapsible sections — locked in DEMO mode (except the “About” section). Close the panel with the full-width “Close” button at the bottom of the window or with Esc:

Font and appearance

Maximum number of groups (32 or 64 — lowering the limit doesn't delete groups above it, it only disables them until you switch back to 64), font size and indent level. The font (a list of typefaces + “Bold”) and the track list text colour apply only to the track names in the Manager table — the rest of the window and the popups keep the regular font. The option “Always contrast the text with the group colour under it” makes the part of a name that sits on a color the chosen text color doesn't stand out from (e.g. white on a yellow group) automatically turn black or white. The “Reset to default” button resets all of these settings.

Window

Corner rounding (px) — separate sliders (0–20 px) for the main window, popups, buttons and fields, the scrollbar, and the slider grab. “Always on top (main window)”, “Always on top (popups)” and “Popups always on the script's screen” (popups open on the Fast Group window's screen: the first time in its center, then wherever you left them) — all three on by default. Popup window — “Popup window scale” (a list from 20% to 200% in 20% steps; 100% = the font size from Font and appearance) and “Bold letters on buttons” (chapter 8).

Colors

Full customization of the interface colors (background, buttons, borders, headers, scrollbar and more), with a button to restore the default colors.

Button colors (Quick add)

A separate color for the green row (Add/Create) and the red row (Remove), with a button to restore the defaults.

Corner rounding (in the Window section)

The rounding sliders are in the “Window” section, under the “Corner rounding (px)” label — see above.

Group badges

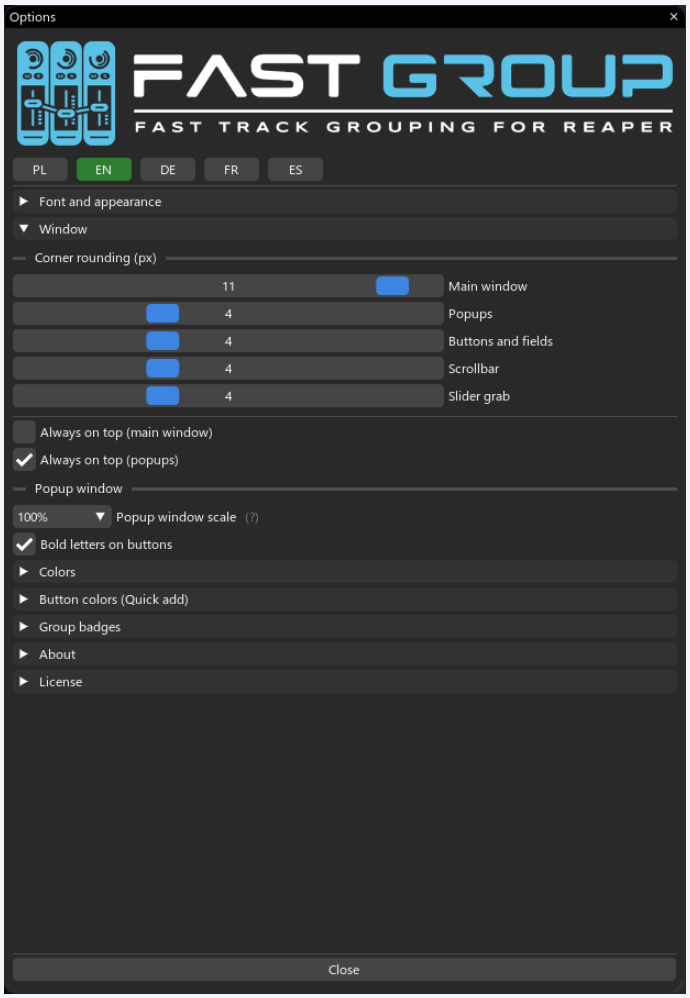
Enable/disable group badges on tracks, brightness and transparency, an option to show the group number when a track belongs to only one, the ring color and thickness for template-based groups, and the width of the group ribbon in the track row (1–100%). More in chapter 10.

About

Name and version, license status, the seller's e-mail (with a Copy button), “Purchase page”, “Customer panel” and “Copy diagnostic info” — include it in your message when reporting a problem (chapter 12). Below it: a link to all scripts, manuals and videos (emelowsky.com/plugins).

License

Shown after activation, last in the panel: the company mark, “License active”, the registration email, the red “Deactivate license” button (with confirmation), and a note about moving your license with the “Open customer panel” button. Everything is in this section — no separate window; see chapter 3.



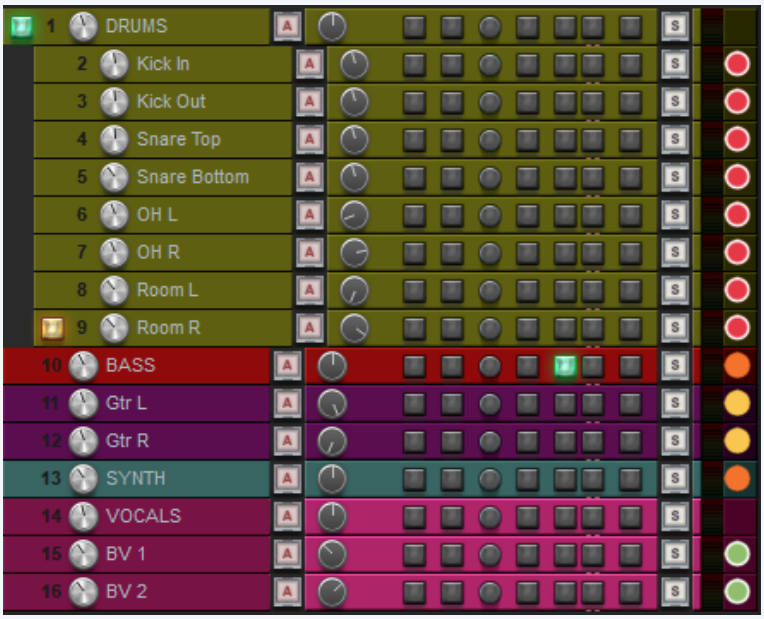
The Options panel with the Window section expanded (including the Popup window settings)

10. Group badges on tracks

Every track belonging to at least one group gets a small, colored badge (icon) on its REAPER track control panel. The color is assigned automatically from a rotating palette — one group, one color. A track belonging to several groups at once shows colored pie slices instead of a solid color.

Groups created from a saved template (chapter 7) get a distinctive ring outline instead of a solid color — brightness, transparency and the ring's look can be adjusted in Options → Group badges.

The same coloring also appears as a ribbon in the track row of the Manager table (section 5.3). Badges are shown only while the Manager is running and sync is on — when you turn the Manager off or switch to Sync: OFF they disappear from your tracks, and they come back when you turn it on again.



REAPER's track panel with group badges: a ring (template group), a solid color and pie slices

11. Troubleshooting

Message / situation	What to do
“ReaImGui not found - install it via ReaPack.”	Install the ReaImGui extension: Extensions → ReaPack → Browse packages…, search for “ReaImGui”, install it, then restart REAPER.
The script doesn't react to its assigned shortcut	Check that the shortcut's Scope is “Global + text fields”, not just “Global” (section 2.2).
Startup error about a missing Core.lua file	All three .lua files must be located in ONE, single folder.
“No tracks selected!”	Select at least one track in REAPER before trying to add to or create a group.
“No parameter selected to link!”	Tick at least one parameter checkbox (V/P/R/M/S/A/W/F) before creating the group.
“Reverse Pan requires exactly 2 selected tracks!”	Reverse Pan only works for groups of exactly two tracks — for more tracks use regular Pan instead.
“Reached the limit of 32 groups.” (or 64)	The full version supports 32 groups per project, or 64 after switching Options → “Font and appearance” → “Maximum number of groups”. You can also remove an unused group (Tools → Clean up unused group data can help) or merge several groups into one.
“DEMO version: maximum 2 active groups…”	This is the DEMO mode limitation (chapter 4) — activate a license to remove it. Groups over the limit are not removed — they wait untouched for activation.

Message / situation	What to do
The track badge colors don't seem to change	Use Tools → Refresh track group badges to force the icons to redraw.
“This license key is not valid for this email and this computer.”	Check that the email is exactly the one the key was issued for, and that you pasted the whole key. If your computer or Machine ID changed, move your license in the customer panel (section 3.3).
“This license has been revoked by the license server…”	This key will not work again. Get a new key in the customer panel or contact the seller (section 3.4).
No internet, or the license server does not respond	Nothing to do — the script keeps working normally, and the license is never deactivated because of it.
The group badges disappeared from my tracks	The Manager is turned off or sync is set to Sync: OFF — grouping is paused then, and the groups stay in the project. Start the Manager or click the chain link (Sync: ON).
A message that “Emelowsky - Fast Group Core.lua” is a shared library	You ran the Core action instead of the Manager or the Popup. Run “…(manager).lua” or “…(Popup).lua”; you can remove the Core action from the Action List (section 2.2).
REAPER 6: the script doesn't start	On REAPER 6 use the files from the “Lua 5.3 (REAPER 6)” folder of the package (or the ReaPack package “Emelowsky - Fast Group (REAPER 6, Lua 5.3)”) — the files in the “Lua 5.4 (REAPER 7)” folder only work on REAPER 7.
The “Fast Group - display scaling (HiDPI)” window or the “frame initialization failed” error	Your screen scaling is above 100% and REAPER is not in the “Multimonitor aware” mode. Options → Preferences → General → Advanced UI/system tweaks → HiDPI mode: “Multimonitor aware” (or “Multimonitor aware v2”), then close REAPER and open it again. Still not working? Right-click the REAPER shortcut → Properties → Compatibility → “Change high DPI settings”: untick the scaling override (or choose “Application”). “Yes” in that window opens the Preferences right away. Close the other error windows (ReaImGui, ReaScript) — the advice about the graphics renderer does not help here.
“Fast Group is already running from another location…”	You have two copies of the script (e.g. a manual install and ReaPack) and one is already running. Keep one: delete the old copy from disk and its actions in the Action List (section 2.2). Until then, close the running copy or restart REAPER.

12. Contact and support

For questions, activation issues or suggestions about the script, write to emelowsky.plugins@gmail.com. Include the diagnostic info: Options → “About” → “Copy diagnostic info”, then paste it into your e-mail (Ctrl+V).

After a script update, a “What's new” window with the list of new features appears once — close it with the Close button.